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Support for Windows 7 will end in 4 months but it will get free security updates for another year. <https://dgit.in/sep19-7>



Tesla price hike in China?

Tesla is reportedly planning to increase Electric Vehicle prices in China starting August 30. <https://dgit.in/sep19-7>

Nubia Red Magic 3

Misses the mark

Mobile gaming has become a phenomenon of sorts in India. Riding on the back of games like PUBG Mobile, consumers in India are demanding smartphones that can handle heavier games. But, does that clear the ground for dedicated gaming phones? Case in point is the new Nubia Red Magic 3. It looks every bit the device that exudes gaming mojo and is packed with cutting-edge hardware to maximise its gaming capabilities. So, how does the Red Magic 3 fare? Let's find out.

Design

Using the Red Magic 3 is difficult if you aren't gaming, simply because of the gigantic display. It's impossible to use it one-handed and is quite bulky. The rear panel is well-designed though. An RGB light strip runs down the center and the top corners are ear-marked with reflective red artifacts. The speaker grill is positioned bang in the center, right below camera module. On the side is a pogo-pin connector where the dock goes in to offer ethernet connectivity, and an additional headphone jack.

Performance

The Red Magic 3 was touted to be the fastest smartphone in the world based on the AnTuTu scores. It has the Snapdragon 855 under the hood, coupled with 8GB RAM and 128GB internal storage in the unit we received. There's also a fan inside the phone, placed on top of the SoC to draw heat away and expel it out through a vent. AnTuTu and Geekbench scores are indeed the highest we have clocked on an Android phone so far, however the 3DMark Slingshot scores are beaten by most of its competitors.

The Red Magic 3 is built for extended periods of gaming. We played PUBG Mobile, Asphalt 9 and few more games



Price
₹35,999



PERFORMANCE.....80
VALUE FOR MONEY.....100
FEATURES.....60

and clocked the performance on Gamebench. The data shows that despite touting superior hardware, the Red Magic 3 somehow isn't able to achieve peak frame rates in all the games. Performance while playing PUBG Mobile is the best. This phone is clearly cut out for maxing

out the capabilities of the game with a registered 60 FPS at an impressive 96 percent stability.

The Red Magic 3 runs on stock Android 9 Pie with the Red Magic theme on top. We didn't like the icon designs. They felt clunky and outdated. However, the UI is smooth, swift and takes advantage of the 90Hz display.

Camera

The single 48MP camera on the back of this gaming phone is not bad at all. The camera hardware includes the 48MP sensor along with an f/1.7 lens without any sort of stabilisation whatsoever. The focus is far away from offering a versatile and flexible camera. There's no hardware-based portrait mode, neither does it have a wide-angle lens, or a telephoto zoom lens. Instead, there is a software-based portrait mode and the single camera does one thing and does it

pretty well. The 48MP mode produces really sharp images even though the dynamic range takes a hit.

The 16MP front camera is also decent, although the beauty filters tend to overdo the skin smoothening thing.

Display and Battery Life

The AMOLED display on the phone stretches to a massive size of 6.65-inches and is HDR+ rated. It also has a refresh rate of 90Hz, same as the OnePlus 7 Pro, but at a much lesser cost. However, it has a full HD resolution, and the colours don't exactly pop-out of the display, which is a shame. The display also has a touch response of 240Hz.

The Nubia Red Magic 3 also packs a massive 5,000mAh battery inside with 18W fast charging support. The battery life is impressive if you keep the CPU and GPU performance in the auto mode. When maxed out and with the fan inside running, the battery drain is actually faster and the battery life is similar to a phone with a 4,000mAh battery. It still manages to easily last a day, even with heavy gaming.

Verdict

The Nubia Red Magic 3 packs a lot of features for a gaming phone, and it's also the most affordable Snapdragon 855-powered gaming unit in the market. Everything from a high refresh-rate display to the ability to tweak CPU and GPU speeds to a literal fan inside the body and RGB lights, this is essentially what we expect from gaming smartphones. But it would've been all the more better if the performance also matched up. Unfortunately, the phone doesn't come across as well-optimised to utilise the sustained high-performance while gaming. There's work to do and Nubia could just as well finish the job via a software update.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.65-inch (1080x2340) | PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 855 | FRONT CAMERA: 16MP | REAR CAMERA: 48MP | RAM: 8GB | STORAGE: 128GB | BATTERY CAPACITY: 5000mAh | OS: Android Pie

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